

Use-Case Flow Specification

Community Lost & Found Matching Network | Problem Statement #59

UC-05: Claim Item (Verify Proof of Ownership)

Primary Actor: Owner

Supporting Actors: Finder (indirectly, via stored security question/answer), System

Preconditions

1. A Lost Item report submitted by the Owner has been matched to a Found Item post (UC-04), and a match notification has been sent.
2. The Owner is authenticated (logged in) and has opened the matched Found Item listing.
3. The Finder set at least one proof-of-ownership security question when creating the Found Item post (UC-01).

Postconditions

Success:

1. The Finder's contact details are revealed to the Owner.
2. The match status is updated to "Claimed – Pending Handover."
3. Both Finder and Owner receive a confirmation notification.

Failure:

1. The Finder's contact details remain hidden and the match status stays "Pending Verification."

Main Success Scenario

1. Owner receives a match notification and opens the matched Found Item listing.
2. Owner selects "Claim This Item."
3. System displays the Finder's proof-of-ownership security question(s).
4. Owner enters answer(s) to the security question(s) and submits.
5. System validates the submitted answer(s) against the Finder's stored answer(s).
6. System confirms the answer is correct.
7. System reveals the Finder's contact details to the Owner.
8. System updates the match status to "Claimed – Pending Handover."
9. System sends a confirmation notification to both the Finder and the Owner.
10. Use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow — 5a. Incorrect Answer

Branches from step 5 of the Main Success Scenario when the submitted answer does not match the Finder's stored answer.

5a1. System displays "Incorrect answer, please try again" and does not reveal contact details.

5a2. Owner is prompted to re-enter an answer.

5a3. If the Owner fails three consecutive attempts, the system locks further claim attempts on that item for 24 hours and notifies the Finder of a suspicious claim attempt.

Flow then resumes at step 1 (a fresh claim attempt) once the lock period ends, or ends the use case in failure if the Owner abandons the claim.

